

The Words of Truth

Toh 815 · Derge Kangyur

བདན་ཆགས་

The text known as The True Words (Tibetan: Dentsik Dzokso) is an invocation of truth, a short verse composition that praises generosity and the offering of fine food and drink, likening such giving to a grove of wish-fulfilling trees and to a clear, steady lamp for beings standing at the brink of saṃsāra. It begins with homage to the Three Jewels and goes on to describe how merit and other benefits arise from giving, so that it serves as an aspiration and a statement of truth, a recitation meant to bring about the blessings it names. A Sanskrit title is not evident from the available source lines, so it is not given here. The text is Toh 815 in the Kangyur, the Tibetan canon of translated words of the Buddha, where it belongs among the shorter works of the tantra section.

The true words are complete. Homage to the Three Jewels.

Fine food and drink, savory and fair in color, fragrant, with rising steam, adorned with every excellent quality; like a grove of wish-fulfilling trees, rare and flawless, covered in ornaments, with branches heavy with clusters of blossoms so that the tips of the boughs bow low, flowers opening and petals beautifully adorned, while bees, drunk and intoxicated, swarm and press upon them so that they tremble and sway gently; and with precious branches and tender, unbroken shoots hanging down and swaying in the breeze, all of these are brought forth. Beings, without even noticing it, stand at the brink of the great abyss of saṃsāra, and this giving is like a lamp burning clear and bright and free of stain. From such giving come merit, causes in harmony with merit, virtue, and causes in harmony with virtue, which are the ground of every happiness.

Therefore may this great benefactor, this person of great and noble nature, whose body is made firm by the ten paths of virtuous action, be endowed with length of life, beauty, strength, splendor, wealth, sovereignty, wisdom, and eloquence. May the benefactor's merit that has not yet arisen come to arise. May the benefactor's wealth that has already arisen increase and flourish.

Likewise, may the benefactor's father and mother, who have undergone the greatest hardship in nourishing, raising, bringing up, and caring for their child, and who have let their child see the radiant world of Jambudvīpa with his own

eyes, receive their due share of the first fruits of this merit.

Likewise, may the benefactor's wives, sons, and daughters, and all the benefactor's relatives, friends, and companions, together with every group of kin who live and dwell in this household, have long lives, great wealth, and many attendants. And may those who have died and passed on from this life obtain a distinguished rebirth, a place of birth different from and better than before. Born in the realm of the gods, may they delight in the presence of the noble Maitreya.

Likewise, may the sovereign lord, the supreme of kings, the great king, the holy ruler, glorious Lha Tsenpo, arrive where he has not yet come, and having arrived, may he come to dwell in peace. May he also attain the kingship of a universal ruler, a turner of the wheel of power.

Likewise, may the people of the land who live in the surrounding villages, of the four classes, the brahmins, the nobles, the merchants, and the commoners, be free from sickness and free from harm.

Likewise, may Brahmā, lord of the world of endurance, Indra (Śakra), lord of the gods, the four guardians of the world, the twenty-eight great generals of the yakṣas, the nāga king Nanda, Upananda, the yakṣa general Sumana, Himavat (the Snowy One), Pañcika, Pañcalaṇḍa and the others, Maṇibhadra, Pūrṇabhadra, and the mother Hārītī with her five hundred sons and her retinue, and furthermore all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, gandharvas, kinnaras, and mahoragas who rejoice in the teaching of the Blessed One, and the gods who dwell in this benefactor's house, and the special gods whom the benefactor venerates, may their splendor and power, and their palaces, increase and flourish. May they be endowed with splendor, endowed with strength, unconquerable by others, and renowned as great. And may the treasures and storehouses of this great benefactor, his herds of cattle, his herds of every kind of livestock, and the plowing and tilling of his fields, flourish as well.

May they guard, protect, and shelter, in accordance with the Dharma, all the doors of work and every undertaking, high and low. May harms be turned back. May what is sought for good purpose become manifest.

In the same way, joined with the faith of this benefactor, may all the harmful sufferings of those born in the hells be calmed. May animals cease devouring one another. May all the sufferings of hunger and thirst of the hungry ghosts (pretas) be calmed. May all the sufferings of human beings, their quarrels,

identity is not established within this passage. Several yakṣa and divine names are rendered by their probable Sanskrit equivalents (Nanda, Upananda, Sumana, Himavat, Pañcika, Mañibhadra, Pūrṇabhadra, Hārītī); the identifications of Pañcalaṇḍa and Pañcika, which the Tibetan gives as two names, are the least certain. The opening simile of the wish-fulfilling grove is syntactically dense, and its images are rendered somewhat freely for flow.

- The Tibetan has a few corrupt or unclear places. The line concerning the pretas' suffering contains a garbled phrase (apparently a scribal corruption), and I have rendered the sense of the calming of hunger and thirst. The final "four joys" (dga' bzhi) is rendered literally; the reference is uncertain and may reflect a textual variant. Several yakṣa names are reconstructed: the five-crested one is Pāñcika, Vaiśravaṇa is the name behind "wealth-giver" (nor sbyin), and Pārśvaja (པཱ་ར་སྤེན་པ་) is a tentative identification. The yakṣa Pāñcika and Hārītī (ཧཱ་རི་ཏི་, "the snatcher") are standard companions in such protective litanies.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.